Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

THIRD REGULAR SESSION

PARLIAMENT RESOLUTION NO. 537

RESOLUTION APPROVING THE SELECTION OF BARANGAY SARMIENTO, MUNICIPALITY OF PARANG, PROVINCE OF MAGUINDANAO DEL NORTE AS THE LOCATION FOR THE BANGSAMORO GOVERNMENT CENTER BY THE COMMITTEE ON THE ESTABLISHMENT OF THE SEAT OF GOVERNMENT OF THE BANGSAMORO AUTONOMOUS REGION IN MUSLIM MINDANAO IN ITS RESOLUTION NO. 001, SERIES OF 2024

WHEREAS, Republic Act No. 11054, also known as the *"Organic Law for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (OLBARMM)"*, provides that the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region, in the exercise of its right to self-governance, is free to pursue its political, economic, social, and cultural development. Further, the Bangsamoro Government shall have the power to create offices and organize its own bureaucracy;

WHEREAS, Section 1, Article VII of the same Organic Law mandates the Parliament to fix by law the permanent seat of the Bangsamoro Government anywhere within the territorial jurisdiction of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region taking into consideration accessibility and efficiency in which its mandate may be carried out under the OLBARMM;

WHEREAS, consistent with the OLBARMM, the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament enacted Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 37, otherwise known as the *"Seat of Government Act of 2023"* on June 19, 2023, which provides for the establishment of the seat of government of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) in the Municipality of Parang, Province of Maguindanao del Norte, amending Book 1, Chapter 2, Section 9 of the Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 13, also known as the *"Bangsamoro Administrative Code;"*

WHEREAS, pursuant to Section 5 of the Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 37, the Committee on the Establishment of the Seat of Government of the BARMM (CESG), which is composed of the Senior Minister as chairperson and the Minister of Finance, and Budget and Management, the Minister of Public Works, the Minister of Environment, Natural Resources and Energy, the Minister of Transportation and Communications, the Chairperson of the Bangsamoro Commission for the Preservation of Cultural Heritage, and the Director-General of the Bangsamoro Planning and Development Authority as members, was created to oversee the establishment of the seat of government of the BARMM in the Municipality of Parang, Maguindanao del Norte, including the identification of the location of the Bangsamoro government center;

WHEREAS, on March 07, 2024, the CESG adopted Resolution No. 001, Series of 2024, identifying Barangay Sarmiento in the Municipality of Parang, Maguindanao del Norte as the location for the Bangsamoro government center;

WHEREAS, the same CESG Resolution was endorsed by the Office of the Senior Minister to the Office of the Parliament Speaker on March 22, 2024;

WHEREAS, Section 5 of the Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 37 provides that the CESG's identification of the location for the Bangsamoro government center shall be subject to the approval of the Bangsamoro Parliament;

WHEREAS, the selection of Barangay Sarmiento as the location for the Bangsamoro government center has been unanimous, as it is considered the most practical and advantageous for the BARMM;

WHEREAS, the identification of the specific site for the Bangsamoro government center is crucial to the establishment of the permanent seat of government of the BARMM;

WHEREAS, on April 26, 2024, the Bangsamoro Government, through the Ministry of Interior and Local Government, conducted a Community Consultation Dialogue for the establishment of the seat of government of the BARMM in Barangay Sarmiento, Parang, Maguindanao del Norte to facilitate discussions with different stakeholders;

WHEREAS, the immediate action of the Bangsamoro Parliament on CESG Resolution No. 001, S. 2024, identifying Barangay Sarmiento in Parang, Maguindanao del Norte as the site for the Bangsamoro government center pursuant to Section 5 of Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 37 is imperative:

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament, To approve the selection of Barangay Sarmiento, Municipality of Parang, Province of Maguindanao del Norte as the location for the Bangsamoro government center by the Committee on the Establishment of the Seat of Government of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao in its Resolution No. 001, Series of 2024.

RESOLVED FURTHER, That the Bangsamoro Parliament shall continue its oversight over the implementation of Bangsamoro Autonomy Act No. 37, also known as the *"Seat of Government Act of 2023."*

RESOLVED, FURTHERMORE, That the CESG shall consult the Bangsamoro Parliament on every major step in the development of the site of the Bangsamoro Government.

RESOLVED, FINALLY, To forward this Resolution to the CESG, for information.

ADOPTED, *Sha'ban* 18, 1446/February 17, 2025.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

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